

Reportage of Socio-Economic Insecurity: A Comparative Analysis of Government and Private Media in Nigeria

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Abstract

Inappropriate media framing has the potential to negatively influence the perception of the audience/masses and downplay issues that ought to have received urgent attention. Thus, if scholarly and practical attention is not given to the manner in which the media frames their news, there is bound to be a problem of marginalisation of pressing socio-economic insecurities, especially due to the political economy of the media. Following an empirical review, the scarcity of scholarly works on broadcast media framing of inflation and cost of living in Nigeria compounds the statement of problem of this study. This study thus examines media reportage of socio-economic insecurity (inflation and cost of living challenges) in Nigeria through a qualitative research design; a comparative content analysis of four purposively selected television news reports; two from Arise News and the other two from the Nigerian Television Authority (NTA). The study thus attempts to answer three major questions: i. How do NTA and Arise News frame its sources on socio-economic insecurity reporting? ii. How do NTA and Arise News frame attribution of responsibility in socio-economic insecurity reporting? iii. Is NTA influenced by the federal government of Nigeria in its reportage of socio-economic insecurity? The study is anchored on the theories of Political Economy of the Media, and Public Sphere, while it adopts an analytical framework comprising Visual, language, attribution of responsibility, and source frames. The study reveals that Arise News prioritises human-interest and citizen-centred narratives, foregrounding lived experiences/socio-economic vulnerability, while NTA adopts a data-driven approach, emphasising official statistics sourced primarily from the National Bureau of Statistics, with minimal human testimony or explicit attribution of responsibility. The study concludes that a balanced integration of human impact, economic explanation, and attribution of responsibility is essential for a more comprehensive and socially responsible media coverage of socio-economic insecurity in Nigeria. The study contributes to media studies and communication scholarship as it closes the knowledge gap of media framing on socio economic insecurity such as inflation and cost of living; providing insights on how a Nigerian government, and private broadcast media frames news.

Keywords: Cost of Living, Inflation, Insecurity, Media Framing, Socio-economic

Introduction

Fadeji et al (2025) assert that media framing, has the potential to influence the perception of the audience/masses and downplay issues that ought to have received critical attention. Thus, if attention is not given to the manner in which the media frames their news, there is bound to be a problem of manipulation and marginalisation of pressing socio-economic insecurities. Moreso, following an empirical review, the scarcity of scholarly works on broadcast media framing of

inflation and cost of living in Nigeria compounds the statement of problem of this research. There are rather scholarly works that examine media framing on insecurities related to violence/wars, creating a conspicuous gap in the academia.

The reality of low attention to matters such as inflation and cost of living is posited by Osisanwo (2025), as he finds that the media gives attention to news that fall under violence and conflict; insecurities, “rather than being viewed as a psychological issue, it is viewed as a form of life-threatening physical damage” (p. 195). He posits that insecurity in Nigeria is identified through issues such as assassination, abduction, trafficking, robbery, gun-violence, banditry, communal clashes, militancy, and terrorism, amongst others (Osisanwo, 2025 p.168). The reason behind this preference of attention both in the academia and media practice can simply be attributed to the theory of News Values. The theory of News Values was propounded by Johan Galtung and Mari Holmboe Ruge to define the newsworthiness of a story, with a focus on television and newspaper medium (Achanya, 2023 p.1); News on physical conflicts are given priority according to the news values theory (Harcup & O'Neill, 2017; Achanya, 2023).

According to the World Bank's Macro Poverty Outlook for Nigeria (April 2024), 10 million Nigerians are in poverty as at 2023 (*The Guardian*, 2024). Moreso, the population lives below the international poverty line of \$2.15 per day, 63.5 % live below the lower middle-income line of \$3.65 per day, and 90.8 % fall below the upper middle-income line of \$6.85 per day (*The Guardian*, 2024). The report attributes this dire situation to structural constraints in the Nigerian economy, including overreliance on oil revenues, low government revenues exacerbated by costly subsidies, inadequate taxation systems, and weak institutional frameworks (*The Guardian*, 2024).

Without citing reports from reputable platforms such as *The Guardian*, anyone living in Nigeria can readily attest to the prevalence and persistence of socio-economic insecurities. Daily life in both urban and rural communities is marked by fluctuating and high prices, inconsistent access to essential services, and the constant pressure of making ends meet amid rising inflation and stagnant wages. A report from the National Bureau of Statistics corroborates this position as it states that between 2023 to 2024, there was a significant rise in percentage of inflation in Nigeria (CPI and Inflation Report June, 2024).

Adejumo writes that even in 2026, Nigerian households continue to struggle with high cost of living, as food prices remain skyrocketed in urban and rural markets, transportation cost are also elevated, against low income (2026). Osisanwo (2025) posits that the reason for insecurity in any nation is attributed to factors such as unemployment and bad governance, amongst others (p. 168).

Over time, this adaptation can lead to normalization, where individuals adjust their expectations and lifestyle to survive within the problems imposed by socio-economic insecurity. Thus, deterring all forms of agitations or protest from netizens to the government or responsible agencies for the prevailing hardship.

Chenge posits that the reason for the inflation is due to internal and external factors such as natural disasters, exchange rate fluctuations, interruptions in global supply chains, and the dramatic increase in commodity prices (2026).

Within this context, the media assumes a critical role; it can function as a catalyst for change by highlighting systemic problems and exposing inefficiencies. Rojas-Calderon (2024) aligns with Fadeji (205), as he posits that “media play a vital role in shaping both public perception and trust in democratic processes...” (p.642). Conversely, media coverage that prioritizes entertainment, or politically driven narratives can obscure these hardships, divert attention, and weaken the populace's collective drive to demand better policies or improved living conditions.

Following the scarcity of such media framing research on the television media, this research aims to undertake a comparative study on the television media through YouTube (NTA Live and Arise News), because of the ease of access/reach by both the researcher and audience. As seen on the NTA Live YouTube channel, there are over 81 thousand follows, while Arise News has over 1.2 million followers.

To guide this investigation, the following research questions have been formulated:

- i. How do NTA and Arise News frame its sources on socio-economic insecurity reporting?
- ii. How do NTA and Arise News frame attribution of responsibility in socio-economic insecurity reporting?
- iii. Is NTA influenced by the federal government of Nigeria in its reportage of socio-economic insecurity?

Literature Review

The concept of Framing was first introduced by Erving Goffman in *Frame Analysis* (1974), where he described frames as the structures that help individuals interpret and make sense of the world (Goffman, 1974). Robert Entman later refined the theory, arguing that to frame is “to select some aspects of a perceived reality and make them more salient or more noticeable, in a communicating text”. (Entman, 1993, p. 52).

Song (2024) aligns with the aforementioned scholars as he writes that “framing is fundamental concept in media and communication studies” (p. 1). “It is the selective presentation of information to highlight specific aspects while downplaying others, thereby shaping audience perceptions and interpretations” (Song, 2024, p.1).

According to Agunblade, the word insecurity is broad, capable of implying different meanings that align with opposing a state of security such as absence of safety, danger, hazard, uncertainty, lack of protection, and lack of safety (2024). Scholars like Ewetan and Urhie, align with the aforementioned position, as they cite same sources and resolve that insecurity can be understood as a condition in which individuals are exposed to danger or the possibility of harm, leaving them vulnerable to physical or material injury (Ewetan & Urhie, 2014). Moreso, Ovwasa, conceptualizes directly from the angle of the government and aligns with the presented positions as he states that insecurity can be viewed as decreased limit and ability of the government to defend and ensure the safety of the nation, property and its citizens against assaults from extremist, kidnappers, and herdsmen in Nigeria (2022).

The structure of the media, particularly its ownership, possesses the capacity to influence how these insecurities are selected, interpreted, and presented to the public. As a result, the same economic condition may be portrayed differently depending on whether the outlet is government-owned or privately-owned. In an instance, a paper titled “Influence of Media Ownership on Media Content. A Case Study of Vision Media Group and Monitor Publications”, by Uster et al., reveals that media ownership influences editorial decision-making and news content, often aligning reporting with owner interests (2025).). In alignment, Fatonji, and Owolabi, in their paper, “Investigating the Impact of Media Ownership Structures on Editorial Independence and News Reporting in Digital Age”, posit that media ownership structures continue to impact editorial content, even with new technologies and platforms; journalists report that editorial independence can be compromised due to ownership dictation/influence, shaping the priorities and presentation of news coverage (2023). A study on media ownership and news objectivity in Nigeria found that large proportions of audiences perceive media owners; whether in government or private, to influence how news is framed (Lawal et al. 2025).

Research on Nigerian state media notes that government-owned media are completely financed and supervised by the government, with typical examples such as the Nigerian Television Authority (NTA), Federal Radio Corporation of Nigeria (FRCN), the News Agency of Nigeria (NAN), amongst others (Oyinloye et al, 2024). In same trajectory, state governments like Rivers State, Ogun State, Bauchi State, to mention a few, in Nigeria, own, finance, and control media outlets such as the Rivers State Broadcasting Corporation (RSBC) (*Rivers State Broadcasting Commission*, 2023); Ogun State Television (OGTV), and Bauchi State Television (BATV) (*Ogun State Television*, 2025; *Bauchi State Television*, 2025).

Government-owned media such as the Nigerian Television Authority (NTA) are often perceived as constrained in their editorial freedom, with audiences acknowledging that government ownership limits the media's ability to uphold principles of truth, fairness/balance in reporting (Ilomuanya et al, 2023).

Privately owned media in Nigeria operate in a highly competitive commercial environment, where commercial success, and audience expectations can significantly influence editorial orientation and. A paper supports the position that advertising revenue and audience engagement play a major role in editorial choices (Adelabu et al). The influence of political interests can also undermine the ideal of autonomy. Analyses of Nigerian media conglomerates reveal that many major private outlets are linked to business interests or political elites, which raises concerns about impartiality, particularly in sensitive coverage areas such as governance and economic policy (Taofeek et al, 2024).

Despite these pressures, privately owned media in Nigeria have also demonstrated the capacity for investigative and issue-driven reporting, as outlets like Premium Times have gained recognition for investigative journalism that highlights corruption and economic hardship (*Premium Times*, 2025). Moreso, private-owned media houses like Arise TV/News, has been presented publicly as an independent and clear-thinking broadcaster, aiming to challenge conventional narratives and offer an African perspective on domestic and continental issues (*Nigeria: “Arise News Channel” Launches Live Broadcasts in South Africa and Nine Other Countries*, 2024). It is worthy of noting that when the National Broadcasting Commission (NBC) issued a warning to Arise TV over alleged “derogatory and incendiary remarks”,

Amnesty International publicly defended Arise's journalistic role, condemning the regulatory action as an attempt to silence independent journalism and limit information freedom (Alex, 2023). Such defensive action by a major and reputable human rights organisation shows external support for Arise TV's role in exercising press freedom and holding authorities accountable.

Having reviewed the concepts of framing, insecurity, and media ownership structures, the study moves to review extant studies in order to clarify the research gap with which this study hopes to fill.

Empirical Review

A review of existing empirical studies shows that a significant proportion of research on insecurity in Nigeria has largely approached the subject from other security perspectives; for instance, a paper examined newspaper coverage of herders-farmers conflict and found that media often failed to handle the topic in a balanced way, influencing public perception of insecurity (Kugbayi, 2024).

Communication scholars such as Joe Chukwu and Sunday Aja, amongst others, research on national newspapers' coverage (*The Sun*, *The Guardian*, and *The Punch*) of herdsman and farmers' clashes in Plateau showed that reporting was dominated by criminality frames and lacked peace journalism emphasis, suggesting gaps in how insecurity is narrated by the press (Aja et al, 2022).

Similarly, another empirical study reviewed newspapers' reporting of herdsman-farmers conflict across Nigerian states and found limited attention to peace-oriented or socio-economic implications of insecurity, underscoring how coverage tends to focus on violence and public reaction rather than root causes (Odiegwu-Enwerem et al., 2021).

Moreso, research investigating media reportage of farmers-herders conflict in North-Central Nigeria, emphasised the ethical obligations of journalists and the influence of reporting on social cohesion, reinforcing that much insecurity research centres on violent conflict reportage (Adams-Osigbemhe, 2025).

A paper examined how newspaper and television report banditry, with results showing that both TV and newspapers did not adequately set the agenda on the problem of banditry in Nigeria (Alphonsus et al, 2022).

A paper examined major Nigerian newspapers such as *The Guardian*, *Vanguard*, and *Punch*, revealing that linguistic choices such as evaluative adjectives, idioms, and rhetoric shape how insecurity is presented, influencing readers' perception and emotion regarding the security situation (Okpala & Chukwu, 2025).

Using a corpus analysis approach, another study examined representations of human security threats in Nigerian newspaper reports from 2020 to 2022, uncovering dominant discourses that portray insecurity as a crisis, war, and broad social challenge; the findings illustrated how textual choices influence audience interpretation of security threats (Osisianwo, 2025).

A paper also contributes to the empirical understanding of insecurity reporting, as there was an investigation into Nigerian newspapers' coverage of crime; examining the emotional and informational impact of insecurity stories on readers (Rufai & Salawu, 2024).

Notably, away from seeing insecurity as cases of violence or terrorism, one of the research works that comes quite close to this study is a paper titled, "The Impact of Mass Media on Public Perception Regarding the Food Crisis and Food Insecurity in Nigeria", showing that mass media significantly shapes public perception of food crises in Nigeria, a component of socio-economic insecurity (Niyiyongu et al, 2025).

In an attempt to synthesise the extant literature on socio-economic insecurity above, three main patterns surface. The first one is the dominance of violent narratives, where the research prioritises armed conflicts such as terrorism, banditry, kidnapping, insurgency, and farmers-herders clashes (Aja et al. 2022; Alphonsus et al, 2022; Adams-Osigbemhe, 2025; Kugbayi, 2024; Odiegwu-Enwerem et al. 2024; Osisanwo 2025).

The second pattern in the Nigerian media scholarship above is media influence on perception; where textual, linguistic, and framing choices such as adjectives, rhetorics, to mention a few, shape public perception regarding national insecurity (Okpala & Chukwu, 2025; Osisanwo, 2025; Kugbayi, 2024; Rufai & Salawu, 2024; Niyiyongu et al., 2025).

The third pattern is on the aspect of print media bias, where the vast majority of empirical investigations center almost exclusively on traditional newspapers (such as *The Punch*, *The Guardian*, *Vanguard*, and *The Sun*), rather than broadcast media (Kugbayi 2024, Aja et al 2022, Odiegwu-Enwerem et al., 2021 Adams-Osigbembe 2025 Okpala & Chukwu 2025, Osisianwo 2025, Rufai & Salawu 2024).

Thus, they tend to underplay other socio-economic dimensions of insecurity, such as rising cost of living, inflation, unemployment, food insecurity, and declining purchasing power. This dominant research orientation leaves limited empirical attention on how the media report non-violent but deeply destabilising socio-economic insecurities. This reinforces the need for studies that shift focus from armed conflict narratives to economic survival and livelihood challenges faced by citizens.

The present study advances Nigeria media scholarship by closing the gap on the examination of framing of non-violent socio-economic insecurities; revealing the recurring patterns with which a typical government-owned, and private-owned broadcast media frame socio-economic insecurities such inflation and cost of living.

Theoretical Framework

The study draws on Political Economy of the Media, which is advanced by scholars such as Herman and Chomsky and Mosco; the theory argues that media messages are shaped by economic interests, ownership structures, and institutional dependencies (Wekesa et al 2020; Ajasa et al., 2025). As established in the literature review, in Nigeria, government-owned media are largely funded and regulated by the same government, while private media depend on advertising revenue and audience ratings/expectations. These conditions can influence editorial independence, source selection, and critical depth, just as Uster et al. (2025) aligns that media

content is shaped by ownership interests. Applying political economy theory allows the study to move beyond surface content analysis, to examine how ownership structures condition reportage of inflation and cost-of-living pressures. In other words, the political economy theory helped to inform the coding categories/units of analysis, as a conscious effort was made to capture how the editorial structures of the selected channels manifested; coding categories were formed to analyse language and visuals as tools of ideological framing, attribution of responsibility as a reflection of institutional bias or elite/government protection, and source framing as an indicator of who holds the power to define the narrative.

Supporting the Political Economy Theory of the Media, the Public Sphere Theory provides a broader democratic context for understanding media reportage of socio-economic insecurity. Developed by Jürgen Habermas (1989), the theory conceptualises the media as a space for public debate, where societal problems are discussed, contested, and negotiated (*Public Sphere*, 2025; Friedland & Kunelius, 2023). Rising cost of living is a public concern that demands dialogue between citizens, and governments, to mention a few. The extent to which government-owned and privately-owned media facilitate inclusive discussion, can amplify or downplay the urgency of socio-economic insecurities such as inflation or cost of living.

While political economy clarifies the structural constraints of the media channels and informed the coding categories/units of analysis, Habermas's Public Sphere Theory shaped the interpretation of the findings by evaluating the quality of democratic deliberation within the broadcast content; data were interpreted based on how effectively the news channels functioned as open forums for rational-critical debate. Specifically, the analysis of sourcing was interpreted through the lens of inclusivity/accessibility; evaluating whether the channels democratised the discourse by including diverse citizen voices or restricted it to political elites or the government.

Methodology

Research Design

The study adopts a comparative qualitative content analysis. This design is chosen by the researchers because the research seeks to screen and analyse audio-visual reportage rather than measure audience responses or effects.

Sampling Technique

Two prominent channels were chosen; Nigerian Television Authority (NTA), representing government-owned media, and Arise News, representing privately-owned media. Though other television stations were not examined before the selection, these stations were purposively selected due to their national reach/digital presence and consistent publication of news content on their official YouTube channels, which serve as accessible and verifiable archives of broadcast material.

Two videos from each channel were purposively selected for their coverage on cost of living and inflation in Nigeria. The reason for the selection of two videos per channel is to have an attempt to see recurring patterns, or a contrast for each channel, and as well to have a contrast/comparison between both channels with different ownership structures. The selection process involved a keyword-based search on the official YouTube channels of both stations

using the terms “cost of living” and “inflation.” The study deliberately restricted the duration of selected videos to not more than five minutes which reflects contemporary online media consumption patterns, where audiences increasingly prefer short, concise news content that allows quick access to information without prolonged viewing time that could be used to entertain other online content.

Data saturation was not considered, because the researcher believes that more videos can be analysed to draw stronger conclusions.

Method of Data Collection

The period covered by the sample is January 2023 to December, 2025, with the first sample from Arise News, broadcast on October 16th 2024, and the second broadcast on June 7th, 2023. The first sample from NTA Live broadcast on April 17, 2025, and the second broadcast on April 16, 2025. The coding/analysis was done manually, and lasted from January to March, 2026 with detailed transcripts produced for each video. Alongside the consideration of the political economy and public sphere theories, the units of analysis were developed inductively, where the authors read through the data, noticed patterns, and named accordingly. Consistency was maintained by giving full attention to one unit of analysis before moving to another, through out the examination of the four reportages. Intercoder reliability was considered as all authors worked on the analysis and arrived at the same finding.

Units of Analysis

- i. Visual Frame
- ii. Language Frame
- iii. Attribution of Responsibility Frame
- iv. Source Frame

Arise News Video 1





Title: Nigerians Struggle as Cost-of-Living Soars

<https://youtu.be/Pf3rbwBA74>

Arise News Video 1

i. Visual Frame:

The visuals accommodate a lot of wide, and medium close-up shots of local sellers and buyers. It also accommodates shots of their shops and markets with which they operate from. This visual framing helps present the realities of inflation and cost of living; showing the affected persons, and commodities that Nigerian consumers struggle to buy due to low purchasing power/low income. Such visual framing can assist with empathy from viewers as they are presented face-to-face with the reality in the market place. Moreover, the numerous close-ups/medium close-ups of Nigerian citizens implies that it is a situation faced by different people who in turn represent the masses/proletariat of the society. The onscreen visualisation of the title of the reportage which reads: “Nigerians Struggle as Cost-of-Living Soars”, aids the aforementioned visuals to present the reportage as a problem in the society

ii. Language Frame

The Language is explicit, piloting the entire reportage through a narrator/presenter. Words such as “The ongoing situation has forced some businesses to close, leaving households grappling with hunger” foregrounds the intensity and urgency of the situation being reported. Language such as “arise news went on the streets of Abuja to speak with residents on the rising cost of food items”, is used to present clarity on the motive behind the coverage/reportage. It also helps reveal clearly, their source of information/objectivity as a media outlet, where the masses are the main informants of the reportage through first hand street interviews. In turn, the language of the interviewees are straight forward, presenting the harsh realities of cost of living with sentences such as “it's nothing to write home about, there is a great difference, skyrocketing, very exorbitant things in the market now”. The repetition of such words by multiple interviewees reflects the authenticity and intensity of the topic being reported.

iii. Attribution of Responsibility Frame

In this report, Arise News frames the responsibility on “food prices”, as they state that “food prices remain a major cause of inflation as food inflation rates hit 37.7”. This frame is faulty because food prices alone can't serve as the subject responsible for inflation. Rather, a human factor such as the government or non-governmental agency can be rationally attributed for the responsibility of inflation and high cost of living because they are animate and accountable, as against “food prices” that is not animate or cannot act on its own.

iv. Source Frame

In this reportage, Arise News frames the source of their information on cost of living and inflation from the National Bureau of Statistics in Nigeria, and majorly, market interviews. This approach legitimises the report as it reports from two main and diverse sources within the Nigerian economy; the National Bureau of Statics is arguably Nigeria's number one site for verifying statistical data, while there is arguably no better source to have first-hand information on cost of living, other than the masses/proletariats who are directly involved.

Arise News Video 2



Title: Enugu Residents Groan Over the Cost of Living
Video Link: <https://youtu.be/-m4IHGpL5IQ>

i. Visual Frame

In this second reportage of Arise News, just like in the first, there is a plethora of medium close-up shots of citizens. There are also multiple shots of petrol stations and its environment. These shots again help present the hardship from real perspectives of citizens; soliciting for empathy

and intervention from appropriate authorities. The visualisation of the petrol meter and long queues help to reveal the harshness of the situation, as the exorbitant price of fuel and delay under the scorching sun is far from normal.

ii. Language Frame

Arise News again uses a narrator to connect the interviews in the reportage, and as well give clarity to what is being reported. For instance, a commentary from the narrator like “Those who are against the removal are saying that ordinary citizens are the most hit following the high cost of living being experienced nation-wide”, puts emphasis on the reality of the hardship within the proletariat, while connecting/introducing the interviewees. Moreso recurring statements from interviewees such as “the common man cannot survive in the next few days to come” intensifies the urgency of the crisis; framing it as a situation that is a threat to life.

iii. Attribution of Responsibility Frame

Through one of the interviewees, Arise News frames the responsibility of the inflation and cost of living on the government, as the interviewee posits that: “...during the inauguration, we were hoping that the country will be better for the new president, but things turned around”.

iv. Source Frame

The source of the reportage is framed from interviews of ordinary citizens on the streets, as well as field observation from petrol stations. The petrol station visited, as observed from the visuals, was the Nigerian National Petroleum Company, popularly known as NNPC, which actually reflects the authenticity of prices from the angle of the government. Thus, having sources from both the government and the proletariat.

NTA Video 1



Video Title: Background Report on Inflation Rise in Nigeria

Video Link: <https://youtu.be/W98XxqAq9lc>

Units of Analysis

i. Visual Frame

Just as seen in the immediate pictures above, NTA adopts visual frames of market places, the city, farm land and machines, food commodities, electricity, and illustration from the national bureau of statistics. These frames reflect that inflation is a reality in the aforementioned areas, especially with the accompanied audio.

ii. Language Frame

The language is dominated with statistical information on inflation from the beginning of the reportage to the end. While this arguably presents figures on increasing inflation, it downplays the human impact, as there are no human voices to directly express their ordeal. This downplay can get worse with viewers who may not be so learned to interpret such level of statistical presentation/grammar. Such viewers will rather better understand their fellow citizens who speak and experience a similar situation.

iii. Attribution of Responsibility Frame

There is no attribution of responsibility through out the reportage, giving room for worry, and suspicion of influence from the federal government of Nigeria.

iv. Source Frame

Source is framed solely from the National Bureau of Statistics, reflecting a one-sided reportage that doesn't capture citizens voices who are experiencing the harsh realities of inflation and high cost of living.

NTA Video 2



Title: Inflation Update for March 2025

Video Link: <https://youtu.be/eDHjUaoAcoc>

Units of Analysis

i. Visual Frame

As seen in the immediate screenshots above, the second reportage of NTA presents frames such as the presenter in a studio, market places, food commodities, and a report from the National Bureau of Statistics in Nigeria. Again, these frames reflect that inflation is a reality in the aforementioned areas, especially with accompanied audio.

ii. Language Frame

Again, the language is flooded with statistical grammar, with no voices of the affected citizens. This statistical grammar, as earlier established, can downplay the urgency and intensity of the hardship caused by the inflation, especially amongst viewers who may not be so learned.

iii. Attribution of Responsibility Frame

There is no attribution of responsibility through out the reportage. This like the previous sampled NTA video raises suspicion on the influence of the federal government in the reportage of NTA.

iv. Source Frame

Again, source is framed solely from the National Bureau of Statistics, reflecting a one-sided reportage that doesn't capture citizens voices who are experiencing the harsh realities of inflation and high cost of living.

Discussion of Findings

While both Arise News and NTA sources its data from the National Bureau of Statistics in Nigeria, Arise News vividly captures the voices of the ordinary citizens, and NTA does not. This one-sided approach of data sourcing by NTA downplays the intensity and urgency of attention to inflation and cost of living. More so, the non-attribution of responsibility on the topic of inflation and high cost of living in both of NTA's reportage is alarming, as this can significantly downplay the need for attention from the government and agencies that are responsible. It implies an influence in the editorial structure of NTA, where the institution is cautious on calling out those responsible for the hardship. The findings thus align with Ilomuanya et al. (2023) who posit that broadcast stations such as the NTA that are government-owned are often perceived as constrained in their editorial freedom to uphold balance in reporting.

Conclusion

This contrast underscores how media outlets can frame the same socio-economic issue; rising inflation and cost of living, either as a human-centered crisis (Arise News) or a statistical and technical economic phenomenon (NTA). The study contributes theoretically to the examination

of framing techniques in the media of television through YouTube. The findings are however methodologically limited as a comparative analysis of four videos (2 from each broadcast channel), may not adequately represent the overall and recurrent framing styles of both stations. Further research is thus proposed to extend the number of analysed videos, in order to arrive at a more significant resolution.

Recommendation

In addition to the proposal of further studies, the study recommends that:

News outlets should balance statistical reporting with human-centered stories because combining personal testimonies with detailed economic explanations can help audiences understand both the lived consequences, urgency, and as well the systemic causes of inflation.

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